

Work and household chores

Speaking Part 1. Task 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Choosing a career path is challenging for teenagers as they transition from school to the workforce. A recent survey shows that 80% of teenagers are unsure of what career they want to pursue, due to lack of exposure to different career options and guidance. One of the biggest challenges for teenagers is lack of work experience, which many employers require. To overcome this, many teenagers pursue internships and apprenticeships to gain experience. Another challenge is the rapidly changing job market with new technologies and industries emerging. To keep up, teenagers must stay informed and continuously learn new skills. Despite these challenges, there are many resources available to help teenagers make informed career decisions. Career counseling and mentorship programs, as well as online resources such as career guides and job search portals, can provide valuable guidance and support. Overall, choosing a career path can be a daunting task for teenagers, but with the right guidance and support, they can make informed decisions about their future.

Speaking Part 1. Task 2

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Household chores in the 21st century have undergone significant changes with the advent of new technologies and household appliances. One of the most notable changes is the rise of smart home devices, such as smart thermostats, smart lights, and robotic vacuums. These devices can be controlled remotely with a smartphone or voice commands, making it easier to manage and automate household tasks. The rise of online grocery delivery and meal kit delivery services have also made it easier to keep the kitchen stocked and prepare meals at home. Laundry and cleaning tasks have also been made easier with the invention of washing machines and dryers, as well as cleaning robots. However, despite the advancements in technology, many traditional household chores such as cooking, cleaning, and laundry still fall on women. A study shows that in 2021, women still spend on average 2.6 hours more on housework than men. With the advancements in technology, it is important to ensure that these tasks are shared more equitably among all household members.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement.

The best driving school in the city!



You are considering attending the driving school and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location;
2. morning classes;
3. minimum age for students;
4. tuition fee.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

We'll help you find a part-time job!



You are considering taking a part-time job in a fast-food restaurant and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. kinds of jobs;
2. salary;
3. skills needed;
4. minimum age.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. Where is your driving school located? Where is your driving school situated?
What's the location of your driving school?
2. Do you have morning classes in your driving school? Can I have classes in the morning in your driving school?
3. What is the minimum age for students to attend your driving school?
4. How much is the tuition fee to study at your driving school? What is the tuition fee in your driving school?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. What kinds of part-time jobs do you offer in your fast-food restaurant?
2. What salary can you pay?
3. What kind of skills do I need to get a job in your restaurant?
4. What is the minimum age of employees to start working in your restaurant?

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss how teenagers help their parents. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Do young people help their parents nowadays? What do you do?

Student: _____

Interviewer: When was the last time you did household chores? What's your attitude towards them?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Would you rather never clean your room? What would your parents say?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you think you will clean your flat when you have one or order a cleaning service? Why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What can encourage teenagers to help their parents around the house?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss the choice of a future career. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Is it difficult for modern teenagers to choose a future career? Why do you think so?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do parents influence their offspring's choice of a future career?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Who or what can help a teenager to choose a suitable career for them?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What did you want to become when you were a child? And now?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What qualities are the most useful in achieving dreams?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. I believe young people help their parents a lot nowadays. They help them cook and they clean their rooms regularly. At least my brother and I do so.
2. I hoovered the flat only yesterday. I like doing household chores. When I do them, I forget about the problems I have now.
3. No, I wouldn't avoid cleaning my room. I like to see it neat and tidy. If I stopped cleaning it, my parents would be very angry. My mom could even say some nasty words to me.
4. When I have my own flat, I will order a cleaning service. Cleaning takes so much time. I'd rather someone did it for me.
5. If teenagers are given more pocket money for helping their parents around the house, this could encourage them greatly. But as I've already said, teenagers do quite a lot of household chores nowadays.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. I think it's not that difficult for teenagers nowadays to choose a future career. They can ask their parents and there are lots of centres where you can try different professions. Teens can watch some videos on the Internet about different professions that could help them make up their mind.
2. I believe parents don't do that much now as they used to. They may give advice but they don't usually make their children choose a career.
3. I think teachers are of substantial help. They may give advice on what a future profession is like. There are also books on how to choose a career. Teenagers can also consult their parents.
4. I wanted to become a doctor. I wanted to help people and cure severe illnesses. Now I want to become a lawyer.
5. I believe perseverance is of utmost importance. You shouldn't give up even if you come across some obstacles. A person also needs to be self-confident and patient.

Speaking Part 4. Task 1

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Part-time jobs". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two part-time jobs;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two part-time jobs;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which of these part-time jobs presented in the pictures you'd prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12–15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Find mistakes in the following student's answer. Assess the answer.

I've found two good pictures for our project "Part-time jobs" and I'd like to tell you about them.

I believe the photos are perfectly suitable because they illustrate different jobs that people can do. In the first picture we can see a woman cleaning a kitchen. In the second picture, there's a waiter in a restaurant. The waiter looks young so I believe she could be working part-time. The difference between the pictures is in the types of jobs the women are doing.

One of the advantages of cleaning is that you can do it alone. Besides, there's no noise. As for working as a waiter, a person can get some tips, which is extra money in addition to the salary.

Unfortunately, there are also some disadvantages of doing these types of part-time jobs. If you clean flats, you have to deal with chemicals all the time which might be harmful for your health. Speaking about work in a restaurant, it's very noisy and a worker should be on their feet all the time, which is physically hard.

I prefer working as a waiter. I think I could get good tips for my work because I'm a friendly and caring person.

That's all for now. Call me back.

Content: ____ point(s)

Organisation: ____ point(s)

Language: ____ point(s)

Overall: ____ point(s)

Answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

The name is not mentioned at the beginning – Hi (Masha) – this is an organisational mistake.

There is no linking phrase when introducing the advantages – it's a logical mistake.

Wrong verb in the last part of the plan – I would prefer to work... - this is a content mistake (+-)

Content: 3 point(s) – one aspect is partly addressed.

Organisation: 1 point(s) – there is no introductory phrase and one mistake in cohesive devices.

Language: 3 point(s)

Overall: 7 point(s)

Writing an email. Task 1

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Pamela:

From: Pamela@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Cleaning
<i>... You know, my parents made me clean my room all day long yesterday. It was in a great mess. How about you? Do you clean your room because you want so or do your parents make you do this? What other household chores do you do around the house? Does everything take long?</i>
<i>Guess what? I got a new bracelet...</i>

Write an email to Pamela.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask **3 questions** about her bracelet.

Write **100–140 words**.

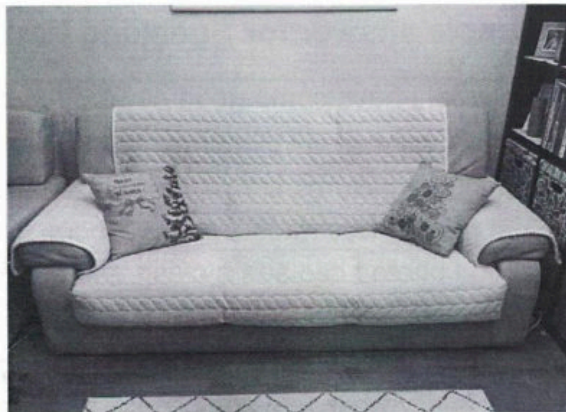
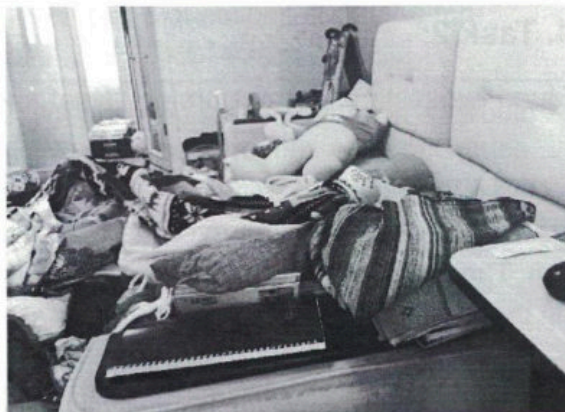
Remember the rules of email writing.

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Neat and clean". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two ways of keeping a flat;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of them two ways of keeping a flat;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which way of keeping your room presented in the pictures you prefer and why;

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Sample answer for Writing an email. Task 1

Hi Pamela,

Thanks for your email. Great to hear from you again!

You told me about cleaning your room all day long. Does it look good now? I always clean my room once a week. My mom never tells me to do so as I do it regularly by myself. As for other household chores, I help my parents load the dishwasher and I sometimes clean the sinks in our bathrooms. It never takes long as our home is usually neat and clean, so we just maintain it in a good condition.

Great news that you've got a new bracelet! Is it wide? What colour is it? Is it made from natural materials or plastic?

I need to help my brother do his homework. Hope to hear from you soon.

All the best,
Nadya

(134 words)

Sample answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Sveta. I have some good news. I have found two pictures for our project "Neat and clean" and I'd like to tell you about them.

Both of the pictures are perfectly suitable because they show rooms in different states. The first picture illustrates a messy room. There are various things all over the place. In the second photo I can see a clean and tidy room. There is a big sofa with two pillows and a cover. The difference between the pictures is in the ways the rooms are kept.

There are both pros and cons of keeping a flat in a mess. You can spend more time with your family when you don't spend all your time on cleaning. However, it's difficult to find things if your flat is in a mess.

There are also some upsides and downsides of keeping a flat neat and clean. The biggest advantage is that you know where all things are and they can be easily found. On the other hand, it requires a great deal of time or money to keep everything in order.

Personally, I prefer to clean my room regularly. I like it when there are neat stacks of books on my table and there's lots of space. It's easier to create things then and I do my homework faster.

That's all for now. Call me back and tell me what you think about the pictures. Bye.

It's not a mistake to speak about advantages and disadvantages of the first idea and then about the second idea. Sometimes it is even more sensible than to discuss upsides first and then downsides as in this very task.

Writing an email. Asking questions

Read a sentence from an email and a task. Then read three questions written by a student. Is everything right?

Our history teacher is taking us to a museum for a field trip next week...

ask 3 questions about the museum.

...Do you like museums? What is your favourite exhibition? How often do you go to different galleries?

What questions will be approved?

Now match the following questions to the tasks. We've deliberately put 3 questions that will not be approved. Identify them and say what the problem is.

1. Next week we'll have a fancy-dress ball at school. I can't wait... - ask 3 questions about the fancy-dress ball.	
2. I'm planning a short vacation – I would like to go to see the museums of Crimea... - ask 3 questions about his trip to Crimea.	
3. I'm planning to take driving lessons soon... - ask 3 questions about his driving lessons.	

How long will you have to study?

What kind of costumes are students going to wear at the ball?

How much is the admission fee?

What kind of transport are you going to use to get there?

How often are you going to study?

Will it start in the afternoon or in the evening?

Where are you going to stay?

How much do the lessons cost?

How long will you trip last?

Why do you want to learn how to drive?

Are you going alone?

Will teachers be allowed to join in or is it only for students?

Answers for Writing an email. Asking questions:

The student's questions will not be approved.

The following questions will be approved:

Is the museum big?

When was it open?

How much is the admission fee?

1. Next week we'll have a fancy-dress ball at school. I can't wait... - ask 3 questions about the fancy-dress ball.	What kind of costumes are students going to wear at the ball? Will teachers be allowed to join in or is it only for students? Will it start in the afternoon or in the evening? How much is the admission fee? – it's a school fancy-dress ball. There's no pay.
2. I'm planning a short vacation – I would like to go to see the museums of Crimea... - ask 3 questions about his trip to Crimea.	What kind of transport are you going to use to get there? Are you going alone? Where are you going to stay? How long will your trip last? – it's stated that it's a short vacation.
3. I'm planning to take driving lessons soon... - ask 3 questions about his driving lessons.	How often are you going to study? How much do the lessons cost? How long will you have to study? Why do you want to learn how to drive? – this question is about his friend, not about the driving lessons.

Writing Task 38. Task 1

Quick questionnaire

Follow the QR-code link or the link below. Answer some questions about who does household chores in your family and see the results of other students ?

Take a picture of the results and write data description. Compare two figures and give a comment. Since it's a real-life opinion poll, the results change all the time, so you can do the task again in a while.

<https://forms.gle/hDXSqCT8txHjpe2t9>



Writing Task 38. Task 2

Fill in the gaps with the following words:

reasonable majority balancing	creating relevant themselves	full-time currently decline	pie chart same as	benefits valuable whether	negatively three adolescents	prioritise position besides
-------------------------------------	------------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-------------------------	---------------------------------	------------------------------------	-----------------------------------

When a person needs money but cannot take a 1) _____ job, it is 2) _____ to work part time. I am 3) _____ doing a project on why teenagers take a part-time job in Zetland. I have found some results of a 4) _____ survey in the form of a pie chart and I want to comment on them.

According to the 5) _____, the 6) _____ of the respondents say that they work part time to get some pocket money (40%). The 7) _____ number of the 8) _____ do it to acquire new skills (14%) and to learn more about different jobs (14%).

Interestingly, 9) _____ times as many of the youth take a part-time job to get work experience (24%) 10) _____ those who want to test 11) _____ (8%). It seems logical as teenagers need to understand 12) _____ they would like their future profession. 13) _____, it could help them get a higher position when they finish studying at university.

Unfortunately, one problem that can arise with doing a part-time job is the difficulty of 14) _____ work and studies. This could 15) _____ affect academic performance and lead to a 16) _____ in grades. One way to solve this problem is by 17) _____ a schedule that includes dedicated time slots for studying and working. It is important to 18) _____ academic work and ensure that it is not neglected in favour of the job.

In conclusion, I believe that a part-time job can play a 19) _____ role in teenagers' lives. It can offer numerous 20) _____ such as learning responsibility, independence, time-management skills, and earning their own money.

Draw the pie chart.

Answers for Writing Task 38. Task 2:

When a person needs money but cannot take a 1) full-time job, it is 2) reasonable to work part time. I am 3) currently doing a project on why teenagers take a part-time job in Zetland. I have found some results of a 4) relevant survey in the form of a pie chart and I want to comment on the them.

According to the 5) pie chart, the 6) majority of the respondents say that they work part time to get some pocket money (40%). The 7) same number of the 8) adolescents do it to acquire new skills (14%) and to learn more about different jobs (14%).

Interestingly, 9) three times as many of the youth take a part-time job to get work experience (24%) 10) as those who want to test 11) themselves (8%). It seems logical as teenagers need to understand 12) whether they would like their future profession. 13) Besides, it could help them get a higher position when they finish studying at university.

Unfortunately, one problem that can arise with doing a part-time job is the difficulty of 14) balancing work and studies. This could 15) negatively affect academic performance and lead to a 16) decline in grades. One way to solve this problem is by 17) creating a schedule that includes dedicated time slots for studying and working. It is important to 18) prioritise academic work and ensure that it is not neglected in favour of the job.

In conclusion, I believe that a part-time job can play a 19) valuable role in teenagers' lives. It can offer numerous 20) benefits such as learning responsibility, independence, time-management skills, and earning their own money.

257 words

